

CHEESE

Coconut Cheddar v3.0

DECISION SNAPSHOT

ADVANCE TO PILOT VALIDATION —

READINESS STAGE

Conditional Advancement · Limited evidence

The sensory screening outcome supports continued development. This is not approval for commercialization or market launch. The sensory GO is supporting evidence only.

CONCEPT VISUAL

Not attached

CORE STRENGTH

Sensory descriptor profile (99/100) is the strongest documented sensory result.

MAIN WATCH POINT

Texture rebuild: Lift overall texture liking by reinforcing creamy, smooth, firm cues through formulation and process controls.

RECOMMENDED NEXT ACTION

Advance to pilot-scale sensory confirmation and target-consumer concept validation before any external launch.

Executive Summary / Commercial Readout

02

A decision memo for product, R&D, design, and commercial leaders.

DECISION

Advance to pilot-scale validation, conditional on closing open items

RATIONALE

The sensory screening outcome is GO. ISSF is 76.7/100 and model confidence is 91%, based on the weighted inputs shown in the method section. Sensory descriptor profile leads at 99/100; Texture performance is the binding risk at 43/100.

EXECUTIVE RECOMMENDATION

Continued development is permitted. Consumer preference, purchase intent, market acceptance, and launch claims are not permitted because concept-test n=0 and launch authorization is not approved.

NEXT MOVE

Pilot-scale sensory confirmation and target-consumer concept validation. Conditions: Bring Texture performance to $\geq 60/100$ at pilot scale and revalidate. Collect target-consumer concept evidence before any consumer or market claim. Obtain claims/legal approval before external distribution.

Product Performance Dashboard

Performance is shown as a commercial decision aid: each result states the evidence and the action or story it supports.

OVERALL SENSORY ACCEPTANCE

84/100



EVIDENCE

Threshold 60/100 · Sensory panel n=14 · Overall liking 7.6/9, Flavour 7.6/9 · benchmark: Trained-panel reference 86/100

SCORE EXPLANATION

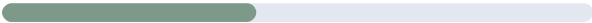
Overall sensory acceptance is calculated from the named sensory-panel measures; see page 4 for weighting.

COMMERCIAL IMPLICATION

The tested panel result supports continued sensory development at the next gate.

TEXTURE PERFORMANCE

43/100



EVIDENCE

Threshold 60/100 · Sensory panel n=14 · Creamy 8.4/10, Smooth 8.6/10 · benchmark: Category readiness line 60/100

SCORE EXPLANATION

Formula: positive-cue average x 105 minus negative-cue average x 45. Firm and spreadable were not captured and count as zero.

COMMERCIAL IMPLICATION

Texture is a commercialization risk and should be optimized before packaging or claims are locked.

SENSORY DESCRIPTOR PROFILE

99/100



EVIDENCE

Threshold 60/100 · Sensory panel n=14 · Cheese 13/14 (93%), Butter 12/14 (86%) · benchmark: Category-positive descriptor target

SCORE EXPLANATION

Sensory descriptor profile is calculated from the named sensory-panel measures; see page 4 for weighting.

COMMERCIAL IMPLICATION

The panel shows high agreement on cheddar-category descriptors; this supports category recognition, not distinctiveness without a comparator.

POSITIVE EMOTIONAL RESPONSE INDICATORS

86/100



EVIDENCE

Threshold 60/100 · Sensory panel n=14 · Positive 4.4/5, Negative 0.8/5 · benchmark: Net emotional valence +3.6

SCORE EXPLANATION

Positive emotional response indicators is calculated from the named sensory-panel measures; see page 4 for weighting.

COMMERCIAL IMPLICATION

The tested panel recorded positive emotional indicators; this is not evidence of representative consumer response.

EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

No concept responses are available. Concept preference and purchase intent have not been validated.

HOW TO READ THESE SCORES

All dimension scores are 0–100, higher is better. ISSF = Integrated Sensory Screening Framework, the composite suitability score behind the GO / TWEAK / STOP decision. Model confidence reflects how complete and consistent the sensory evidence is — not market demand. Evidence populations are labeled separately: Sensory panel n=14; concept test n=0.

Method and Evidence Integration

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Method NFI-GST-1.1 / NFI-GST-1.1. The calculation below makes the decision reproducible.

Dimension	Score	Weight	Contribution
Sensory acceptance	84.0	31.6%	26.5
Texture	43.0	26.3%	11.3
Descriptor profile	99.0	26.3%	26.1
Emotional response	86.0	15.8%	13.6

ISSF REPRODUCTION AND CRITICAL-GATE LOGIC

$ISSF = (77.5 \times 0.86) + (72.3 \times 0.14) = 76.8$. Texture performance (43/100) is below the 60/100 dimension caps the outcome at conditional advancement: the sensory screening supports continued development, but not unrestricted GO or launch.

Model-confidence input	Score × weight	Contribution
Trained-panel agreement	$88.8 \times 45\%$	40.0
Instrument QC recovery	$96.0 \times 20\%$	19.2
GC-MS/olfactometry coverage	$92.0 \times 20\%$	18.4
Descriptor evidence coverage	$88.0 \times 15\%$	13.2

Instrumental findings are itemized below and are included in the decision snapshot.

Source	Finding	Benchmark	Decision effect
E-tongue / composition model	Instrument signal 72.3/100 from taste and composition inputs	Production ISSF instrument-signal transform	supports
GC-MS / GC-O	2 aroma findings; no critical off-note gate failure	Off-note decision gate	supports
Internal-standard QC	Recovery 95.1%	Pass range 85–110%	supports

Key Commercial Insights

The strongest commercial conclusions from the current evidence, translated into decisions for product, design, and go-to-market teams.

1 Sensory descriptor profile is the lead proof point

WHAT THE EVIDENCE SUGGESTS

Sensory descriptor profile is the highest decision dimension at 99/100.

WHY IT MATTERS COMMERCIALY

The panel shows high agreement on cheddar-category descriptors; this supports category recognition, not distinctiveness without a comparator.

RECOMMENDED ACTION

Build the first buyer-facing message around sensory descriptor profile and preserve it through scale-up.

2 Texture performance sets the development agenda

WHAT THE EVIDENCE SUGGESTS

Texture performance is the lowest dimension at 43/100.

WHY IT MATTERS COMMERCIALY

Texture is a commercialization risk and should be optimized before packaging or claims are locked.

RECOMMENDED ACTION

Lift overall texture liking by reinforcing creamy, smooth, firm cues through formulation and process controls. Recheck the dimension after the next prototype.

3 Capture concept descriptors to sharpen the product story

WHAT THE EVIDENCE SUGGESTS

No concept descriptors have been captured yet (no concept responses recorded).

WHY IT MATTERS COMMERCIALY

Without panelist-described language, buyer-facing copy would rely on invented marketing terms that the evidence does not support.

RECOMMENDED ACTION

Add a check-all-that-apply descriptor question to the concept test and collect a target-consumer panel before locking copy.

4 Keep concept conclusions proportional to the study

WHAT THE EVIDENCE SUGGESTS

0 responses provide limited concept evidence.

WHY IT MATTERS COMMERCIALY

The direction is useful for iteration, but it is not yet a demand forecast or representative consumer claim.

RECOMMENDED ACTION

Run a broader target-consumer validation before final packaging, volume assumptions, or demand claims.

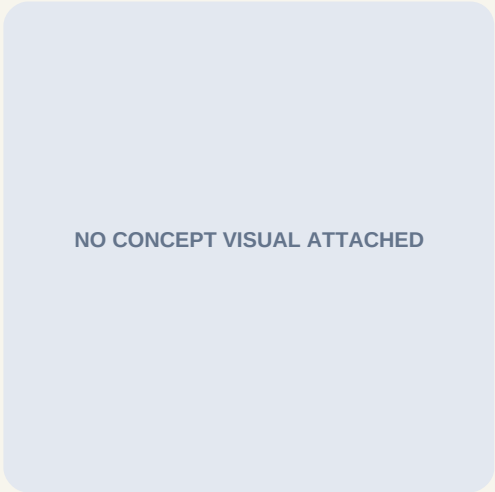
Concept and Packaging Direction

How the product should be positioned, expressed, and refined before external use.

VitaCheese

A plant-based coconut cheddar positioned for everyday use.

POSITIONING HYPOTHESIS	Hypothesis - For flexitarian shoppers seeking a familiar plant-based cheddar for everyday cooking, Coconut Cheddar v3.0 proposes recognizable cheddar-category cues in a coconut-based format.
TARGET SEGMENT	Hypothesis: flexitarian households and plant-based shoppers who prioritize familiar cheddar cues, melting utility, and routine meal versatility.
CONSUMER NEED	Hypothesis: a dairy-free cheddar alternative that feels familiar and practical in cooked meals.
USAGE OCCASION	Hypothesis: burgers, hot sandwiches, toasties, and simple weeknight meals.
PRODUCT PROMISE	Hypothesis: familiar cheddar-category character with a creamy, smooth eating experience.
PRICE HYPOTHESIS	Hypothesis — Test \$5.99-\$7.49 per 7-8 oz pack against format, competitive set, and willingness to pay. Validation required; no willingness-to-pay evidence has been collected.



DIRECTIONAL CONCEPT VISUAL

REASONS TO BELIEVE

Reference panel agreement on cheddar-category descriptors: cheese, butter, lactic acid, and milk • Reference creamy and smooth intensity results • Reference instrumental record with no critical off-note gate failure

PACKAGING HYPOTHESIS

The directional packaging expresses the VitaCheese positioning and is a review stimulus, not final artwork.

VALIDATION AND CLAIMS BOUNDARY

Does the concept communicate plant-based cheddar clearly? • Does coconut naming create positive or negative expectations? • Which usage occasion feels most credible? Prohibited without evidence: Consumer preferred, Purchase intent validated, Market-ready or launch-ready, Distinctive, unique, superior, or category-leading, Nutrition, health, sustainability, or clean-label claims.

Commercialization Plan

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Each workstream shows the accountable owner or an explicit ownership gap, the required evidence, and the passing criteria for the next gate.

Workstream	Current read	Required action	Status / owner
Pilot formulation and process	Open - critical priority - R&D / Process Development · Owner: Not assigned - readiness gap · Due: not scheduled	Produce a pilot batch with documented formula, process conditions, and batch genealogy. Completion evidence: Approved pilot batch record and retained sample Pass: Batch is reproducible and suitable for sensory, instrumental, shelf-life, and packaging validation.	Priority: high · Gate: Pilot validation · Dependencies: pilot batch, locked process conditions, and sensory panel availability
Texture and functionality	Open - critical priority - R&D / Sensory · Owner: Not assigned - readiness gap · Due: not scheduled	Measure firmness, spreadability, melt, oiling-off, sliceability, and overall texture liking against a defined target. Completion evidence: Pilot-scale sensory and instrumental texture dataset Pass: Texture score >=60/100, sensory panel n>=18, and no critical functionality failure.	Priority: high · Gate: Pilot validation · Dependencies: pilot batch, locked process conditions, and sensory panel availability
Consumer concept validation	Open - high priority - Consumer Insights / Commercial · Owner: Not assigned - readiness gap · Due: not scheduled	Test positioning, naming, usage occasion, packaging, price, and purchase intent with the defined target population. Completion evidence: Clean concept-test dataset with documented target-panel fit Pass: Concept test n>=30 with predefined pass/watch/fail thresholds and no unsupported market conclusion.	Priority: high · Gate: Concept validation · Dependencies: approved stimulus, target-segment screener, and fieldwork sample
Shelf life and package	Open - high priority - Quality / Packaging · Owner: Not assigned - readiness gap · Due: not scheduled	Define package format and run microbiological, chemical, physical, and sensory shelf-life validation. Completion evidence: Shelf-life protocol, package specification, and approved results Pass: Product remains within safety, quality, texture, aroma, and package-integrity limits through the proposed life.	Priority: high · Gate: Commercial preparation · Dependencies: validated proposition, pack architecture, and claims review
Claims and regulatory	Open - high priority - Legal / Regulatory · Owner: Not assigned - readiness gap · Due: not scheduled	Create a claim-by-claim substantiation matrix and review ingredients, allergens, nutrition, naming, and label requirements. Completion evidence: Signed regulatory and legal review record Pass: Every external claim is approved and mapped to evidence; unresolved claims are removed.	Priority: high · Gate: Claims approval · Dependencies: claim matrix, substantiation files, and legal reviewer

NEXT DECISION GATE

Next gate: pilot-scale sensory confirmation plus broader target-consumer concept validation.

Risks and Watch Points

These are the issues most likely to change the commercial decision, weaken the buyer story, or delay launch readiness.

Risk	Commercial impact	Mitigation	Next decision gate
Product risk Texture rebuild: Lift overall texture liking by reinforcing creamy, smooth, firm cues through formulation and process controls.	A changed or inconsistent product experience could invalidate the current sensory screening outcome.	Set pilot-scale acceptance ranges and repeat the critical sensory measures.	Pilot validation
Concept/packaging risk No packaging direction is selected.	Buyer feedback may focus on unfinished design choices instead of the product proposition.	Label the stimulus as directional and complete design refinement before external use.	Design review
Claims risk Sensory and concept results do not independently substantiate broad benefit claims.	Unsupported copy creates legal exposure and can undermine buyer confidence.	Create a claim-by-claim evidence matrix and obtain legal approval.	Claims approval
Evidence/source risk Concept read is based on 0 responses.	Directional preference could be overstated as representative demand.	Document panel fit and expand validation before making broad market claims.	Evidence review
Execution risk Owners and completion dates are not stored in the report snapshot.	Open actions can drift across R&D, design, legal, and commercial teams.	Assign one accountable owner and due date to every plan row.	Readiness review

CLAIMS AND LIMITATIONS

No concept responses have been collected, so consumer preference and purchase-intent claims are unsupported. Texture performance (43/100) is below the readiness line and must be remediated before any performance claim. Substantiate every sensory, nutrition, and benefit claim against named evidence and complete legal review before external use.

Appendix / Source Record

Traceability fields are retained here so the commercial story remains readable while every decision can still be audited.

Decision record ID	8a9dd594-626a-42ff-8cdf-3dc49166e150
Decision fingerprint	699B8585
Method ID	NFI-GST-1.1
Report version	5
Export timestamp	2026-06-19T23:56:30.443Z
Concept visual provenance	No concept visual attached.
Evidence populations	Sensory panel n=14; concept test n=0; 3 instrumental findings recorded. Replicate counts are stated per instrumental source where available.
Evidence provenance	Reference/demo dossier - replace with collected client evidence before approval or external use.
Instrumental evidence	E-tongue / composition model: Instrument signal 72.3/100 from taste and composition inputs GC-MS / GC-O: 2 aroma findings; no critical off-note gate failure Internal-standard QC: Recovery 95.1%
AI provenance	No AI-generated report visual used.
Conditions	Bring Texture performance to >=60/100 at pilot scale and revalidate. Collect target-consumer concept evidence before any consumer or market claim. Obtain claims/legal approval before external distribution.
Approval status	draft

APPROVAL AND DISTRIBUTION

Working report version. Cross-functional approval is required before external distribution.